

RAS Preliminary Examination

Syllabus Changes: 2024 vs 2026

Rajasthan Public Service Commission, Ajmer | New syllabus dated 09-01-2026

At a Glance

The exam pattern is unchanged: one objective paper, 150 questions, 200 marks, 3 hours, with 1/3 negative marking, at Bachelor's degree level. What changed is the content of the syllabus - every one of the ten subject areas was rewritten. The revision broadly shifts toward conceptual/thematic framing (especially in History and Economy), adds Rajasthan-specific weight, and introduces several entirely new topics.

Biggest new additions to study

- Indian History: "Indian Knowledge and Value System" - Varna Ashram, Purushartha, Sanskara, Philosophy & Education System (brand new).
- Rajasthan History: "Sources of Rajasthan History" - Archaeological, Archival, Literary and Numismatic (brand new).
- Modern Indian History now extended to 2000 (was 1964); adds British imperialism & resistance (Maratha, Mysore, Sikh), Revolt of 1857, partition.
- Polity (India): Citizenship, Emergency provisions, Local Government, UPSC, National Commission for Women, NCPCR, Social Audit & Grievance Redressal (all new).
- Polity (Rajasthan): Detailed administrative hierarchy (Chief Secretary down to Tehsildar), Subordinate Courts, Advocate General, Board of Revenue, State Women Commission.
- Economy: Fiscal Federalism & Finance Commission, Skill Development & Employment Generation (new); a more thematic economics structure.
- Geography of Rajasthan: Livestock and Urbanization added as topics.
- Science & Tech: Govt programs/policies on S&T, recent advancements, contribution of Indians & indigenization (new).
- Current Affairs: now "with special reference to Rajasthan"; adds Awards/Publications/Authors AND the Rajasthan Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means in Recruitment) Act, 2022.

Notable removals

- Rajasthan History: named dynasties (Guhila, Pratihara, Chauhan, Parmar, Rathore, Sisodiya, Kachchawa) and "Classical Dance" dropped from explicit listing.
- Indian History: "Development of Language & Literature (Sanskrit, Prakrit, Tamil)" removed.
- Geography of India: explicit Power Resources and National Highways/Transport Corridors removed.
- Geography of Rajasthan: Major Industries, Power Resources, Tourist Circuits dropped from explicit listing.
- Economy: GST, Banking, Accounting, Stock Exchange/Share Market, Subsidies/PDS, e-Commerce, Inflation, Happiness Index dropped as explicit items.
- Polity (India): CAG, and explicit Federalism/Coalition Governments/National Integration removed.
- Science & Tech: "Blood Groups and Rh Factor" removed.
- Reasoning: "Mirror / Water images" removed.

Note: "Removed" means the topic is no longer named explicitly in the syllabus. Some may still be examinable under broader headings (e.g. inflation under monetary policy). Treat removals as de-emphasised, not guaranteed out of scope.

Section-by-Section Comparison

1. History, Art, Culture, Literature, Tradition & Heritage of Rajasthan

Adds a new "Sources of History" topic and "Religious practices"; removes named dynasties and explicit Classical Dance.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Historical Rajasthan: Important historical centres of Early Christian Era; Society, Religion and Culture in Ancient Rajasthan.	Pre-historical sites + "Society and Culture of ancient Rajasthan."
(no equivalent)	NEW: "Sources of Rajasthan History: Archaeological, Archival, Literary and Numismatic."
Dynasties named: Guhila, Pratihara, Chauhan, Parmar, Rathore, Sisodiya, Kachchawa.	Named dynasties removed; reframed as "Cooperation and Resistance with central power."
Emergence of Modern Rajasthan; role of newspapers & political institutions; Praja Mandal movements.	"Political and Social condition in 18th-19th Century"; Praja Mandal & Mass awakening; Integration.
Architecture: temples, forts, palaces, man-made water bodies. Performing Art: Classical Music & Classical Dance; Folk Music; Folk Dances & Drama.	Adds "Monuments." Performing Art reorganised: "Folk Dances & Drama. Music (Classical and Folk) & Instruments." Classical Dance dropped.
Religious Life: Communities, Saints, Sects, Folk Deities.	Adds "Religious practices."

2. Indian History

Heavily reframed. New "Indian Knowledge & Value System" topic; modern period extended to 2000 with imperialism/1857/partition added; ancient language-literature dropped.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Ancient: "Renunciatory tradition and new religious ideas of 6th Century BC."	"Religious ideas of 6th Century BC" (phrase trimmed).
Art and Architecture in Ancient India.	"Art and Architecture & scientific development in Ancient India."
Development of Language & Literature in Ancient India: Sanskrit, Prakrit and Tamil.	REMOVED.
(no equivalent)	NEW: "Indian Knowledge and Value System: Varna Ashram, Purushartha, Sanskara, Philosophy and Education System."
Sultanate: prominent Sultanate Rulers; Cultural achievements of Vijaynagar. Mughal: challenges & reconciliation (Afghan, Rajput, Deccan, Maratha).	Sultanate: "prominent dynasties"; Political & Cultural achievements of Vijaynagar empire. Mughal: "Administration and various policies; Marathas."
Modern Period: early 19th century to 1964. Focus on Intellectual awakening, Press, Western education, socio-religious reforms.	Modern Period extended to 2000. Adds British Imperialism & Resistance (Maratha, Mysore, Sikh), Revolt of 1857, British policies; Revolutionary movements & partition; Planning & Economic reforms.

3. Geography of World and India

World geography adds Natural Vegetation & Transport Network. India geography adds Irrigation but drops Power Resources and Highways; topics generalised.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
World: Major Landforms; Types of Agriculture; Major Industrial Regions.	World: "Physical Aspects"; Natural Vegetation (new); "Agriculture: Type, Distribution & important crops"; Industrial Regions & Industries; Transport Network (new).
India: Major Landforms; Mechanism of Monsoon & Rainfall; Major Crops (named); Minerals (named); Power Resources; National Highways & Transport Corridors.	India: Physiographic division; Climate; Irrigation (new); "Agriculture: Important Crops"; Minerals (Metallic/Non-Metallic). Power Resources and National Highways REMOVED.

4. Geography of Rajasthan

Adds Livestock and Urbanization; drops Major Industries, Power Resources and Water Conservation; crops generalised.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Major physiographic regions; Major Industries; Major Irrigation Projects & Water Conservation Techniques; Power Resources; Tourist Centres & Circuits.	Location, Extent & Physiography; Irrigation; Tourism. Major Industries, Power Resources, Water Conservation REMOVED.
Major Crops (named); Population incl. Major Tribes.	"Agriculture" (generalised); adds Livestock and Urbanization; Tribes listed separately.

5. Indian Constitution, Political System & Governance

Adds Citizenship, Emergency provisions, Local Government, UPSC, NCW, NCPCR, Social Audit & Grievance Redressal. Drops CAG and explicit Federalism/Coalition topics.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Philosophical Postulates; Constituent Assembly; Salient features; Amendments. FR, DPSP, FD.	Framing of the Constitution; Preamble; Citizenship (new); FR, DPSP, FD.
President, PM & Council, Parliament, Supreme Court & Judicial Review.	Union Government - Executive, Legislature and Judiciary. Adds Union-State Relations & Emergency provisions; Urban & Rural Local Government.
ECI, CAG, NITI Aayog, CVC, Lokpal, CIC, NHRC.	ECI, UPSC (new), NHRC, National Commission for Women (new), NCPCR (new), NITI Aayog, Lokpal, CVC, CIC. CAG removed.
Federalism, Coalition Governments, National Integration. Public Policy, Legal Rights, Citizen's Charter.	Public Policy, Citizen Charter, Social Audit (new), Grievance Redressal (new). Federalism/Coalition/National Integration dropped as explicit items.

6. Political and Administrative System of Rajasthan

Much more detailed on administrative machinery and judiciary. Adds Advocate General, Board of Revenue, State Women Commission; drops the standalone Public Policy/Rights line and SHRC.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Governor, CM & Council, Legislative Assembly, High Court.	Adds Subordinate Courts & other judicial bodies, Advocate General.
District Administration, Local Self Government, Panchayati Raj.	Detailed hierarchy: Chief Secretary, State Secretariat, Directorates, Divisional Commissioner, District Collector/DM, SP, SDO, Tehsildar.
RPSC, State Human Rights Commission, Lokayukt, SEC, SIC.	RPSC, State Election Commission, Information Commission, State Women Commission (new), Board of Revenue (new), Lokayukt. SHRC dropped.
Public Policy, Legal Rights and Citizen's Charter.	REMOVED as a separate item; coverage shifts to administration & Panchayati Raj/Municipalities.

7. Economic Concepts and Indian Economy

Restructured into a thematic, economics-honours style. Adds Fiscal Federalism, Finance Commission and Skill Development; drops many discrete items (GST, banking, accounting, stock market, inflation, etc.).

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Basic Concepts: Budgeting, Banking, Public Finance, GST, National Income; Accounting; Stock Exchange & Share Market; Fiscal & Monetary Policy; Subsidies, PDS; e-Commerce; Inflation.	Reframed thematically: Economic Growth & Development; Sustainable Development; Measurement of Development (HDI & indices); Monetary & Fiscal Policy; Recent Union Budget & Resource Mobilization. GST, Banking, Accounting, Stock Exchange, Subsidies/PDS, e-Commerce, Inflation dropped as explicit items.
Human Resource: HDI, Happiness Index, Poverty & Unemployment. Social Justice.	Adds Fiscal Federalism & Finance Commission (new); Agricultural/Industrial/Service-sector development; Skill Development & Employment Generation (new); Social Justice & Empowerment. Happiness Index dropped.

8. Economy of Rajasthan

Adds State Budget, Rural Development/State Finance Commission and Basic Social Services (Education & Health).

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Macro overview; Agri/Industrial/Service issues; Growth, Development & Planning; Infrastructure & Resources; Major Development Projects.	Macro overview & State Budget; Sector status, issues & govt initiatives; Infrastructure (Energy, Transport, Communication).
(no equivalent)	NEW: Rural Development, Panchayati Raj & State Finance Commission; Basic Social Services - Education & Health.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Welfare schemes (detailed beneficiary list: SC/ST/BC/Minorities/Disabled/Women/Children/Old age/Farmers/Labourers).	"Major Welfare Schemes of Government of Rajasthan" (generalised).

9. Science & Technology

Adds govt S&T programs/policies, recent advancements, Indian contributions and indigenization; adds "Inheritance and variation"; drops Blood Groups & Rh Factor.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
Defence Technology, Space Technology and Satellites.	"Defence and Space Technology with special reference to India."
Nanotechnology, Biotechnology and Genetic Engineering. Food & Nutrition, Blood Groups & Rh Factor.	"Inheritance and variation; Genetic Engineering, Biotechnology and Nanotechnology." Blood Groups & Rh Factor REMOVED.
Health care; Infectious, Non-Infectious & Zoonotic diseases.	Human Health Care; Food & Nutrition; Diseases and Public Health Programs.
Development of Science & Technology (Rajasthan).	NEW: Key Govt Programs & Policies on S&T (Rajasthan & India); Recent advancements; Contribution of Indians; Indigenization of S&T.

10. Reasoning & Mental Ability

Adds Critical Reasoning, Ranking & Sitting Arrangement, Profit and Loss; removes Mirror/Water images.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
"Logical Reasoning." Analytical Reasoning.	"Reasoning." "Analytical Reasoning / Critical Reasoning" (Critical Reasoning added).
Mental Ability includes Mirror / Water images.	Mirror / Water images REMOVED; "Ranking and Sitting Arrangement" added.
Basic Numeracy: Ratio, Proportion and Partnership.	Adds "Profit and Loss."

11. Current Affairs

Reoriented toward Rajasthan. Adds Awards/Publications/Authors and the Unfair Means in Recruitment Act, 2022.

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
"Current Affairs." Events of Rajasthan/India/International; Persons, Places, Institutions in news; Games & Sports.	"Current Affairs & Issues (with special reference to Rajasthan)." Adds Newly launched welfare/development schemes; economic & political developments.
(no equivalent)	NEW: Major Awards, Publications & distinguished Authors.
(no equivalent)	NEW: Rajasthan Public Examination (Measures for

RAS Pre 2024	RAS Pre 2026 (Dated 09-01-2026)
	Prevention of Unfair Means in Recruitment) Act, 2022.

How to read this document

- **Green cells** = new content / additions in the 2026 syllabus.
- **Red cells** = content removed or no longer explicitly listed in 2026.
- Uncoloured cells = reworded or reorganised, broadly equivalent coverage.

Source documents: RAS Pre 2024 syllabus and RAS Pre syllabus dated 09-01-2026, RPSC Ajmer.